

JOINT PROPOSAL ON THE IMPROVEMENT OF DIVERSIFICATION OF THE WTO SECRETARIAT

By Brazil, China, Cuba, Ecuador, India, Pakistan, South Africa

1. We appreciate the efforts by the WTO Secretariat to improve the diversification of its composition. However, based on the statistics provided by the Secretariat on its website (http://www.wto.org/english/thewto_e/secre_e/intro_e.htm) by October 9, 2009, diversification obviously remains a serious systemic issue. Nationals from developing Members, which constitute more than two thirds of WTO Membership, amount to only one fifth of the total Secretariat staff. And nationals from the top eight Members, those with most nationals in the total Secretariat staff, amount to nearly 70 per cent and they are all developed ones.

2. While recognizing that merits should be one, but not the only one, of the key elements to consider applications, we believe that diversification must remain a long-term and key element in the WTO secretariat recruitment policy and concrete measures must be taken to constantly improve the situation. Relevant practices of other international organizations will provide important experiences for us to share:

- (a) Under the item of “Nationalities” of the recent Vacancy Announcement D2013 of WIPO published on 16th November 2009, it is clearly indicated that: “*Other qualifications being equal, preference is given to candidate who are nationals of one of the Member States of WIPO and the candidates from regions of the world from which the number of WIPO staff is insufficient.*”
- (b) The Statement of Diversity of IMF on January 4, 2008 pointed out that: “*An IMF staff that reflects the diversity of its membership will enhance legitimacy and understanding of the Fund’s role, and strengthen the Fund’s ability to serve its member countries.*” (<http://www.imf.org/external/hrd/diversity.htm>).
- (c) The recruitment policy of the United Nations University reads: “*While recruiting only the most able and technically competent candidates, we strive for balance in gender and nationality representation. We do not set country or gender quotas, but we do try to ensure that the diversity of UN member states is reflected in the composition of our staff. Where competing candidates exhibit equal merit, preference is given to candidates from developing countries or regions and every effort is made to achieve a balanced gender distribution within the organisation.*” (<http://www.inweh.unu.edu/vacancies.htm>)
- (d) The *Diversity & Inclusion of the World Bank Group* reads: “*Diversity & Inclusion are at the heart of how we define excellence...Our diversity is our comparative advantage as a global knowledge and development organization...We do not just recognize our diversity; through inclusion, we mobilize it. We are working to create an inclusive and respectful work environment where we demonstrate that we fully*

value the contributions of all staff...Diversity & Inclusion are key to our success as a global development organization.”

<http://web.worldbank.org/WBSITE/EXTERNAL/EXTHRJOBS/0,,contentMDK:20522369~menuPK:1353275~pagePK:64262408~piPK:64262191~theSitePK:1058433,00.html>

3. We urge the Committee on Budget, Finance and Administration (CBFA) to initiate a permanent process of discussion on the issue of diversification in various formats. To facilitate such discussion, we suggest that the following measures be taken:

- (a) To instruct the Secretariat to prepare a thorough evaluation of the diversification issue and report to the CBFA by March 1st 2010. Such report should also include recommendations on how to improve the situation;
- (b) To include diversification as a permanent item on the agenda of the CBFA for formal discussions complemented by other forms of consultation;
- (c) To instruct the Secretariat to report separately on the diversification issue annually at the last CBFA meeting, including information on the state of play, measures taken and effects;
- (d) To report on the diversification issue to the General Council annually at its last meeting, including recommendations for the General Council to take necessary actions.

4. Finally, this joint proposal remain open for all other interested Members to co-sponsor.
